

Exploring CSS counter()



`counter()` is a CSS function used for automatically numbering.

It works with `counter-reset`, `counter-increment`, and `content` properties to create a numbering system without having to assign them manually.

Complete Full-Stack Roadmap



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Setup a counter

To setup a counter, you need to:

- Initialize the counter with `counter-reset`
- Increment the counter with `counter-increment`
- Display the counter with `content`

```
1  /* start a counter named "section" */
2  body {
3      counter-reset: section;
4  }
5
6  /* increment for each h2 heading */
7  h2 {
8      counter-increment: section;
9  }
10
11 /* display counter value, followed by a
   dot */
12 h2::before {
13     content: counter(section) ". ";
14 }
```

1. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

2. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

Customize counter style

You can customize the numbering by passing a `<list_style>` parameter to `counter()`.

```
1  body {  
2      counter-reset: section;  
3  }  
4  
5  h2 {  
6      counter-increment: section;  
7  }  
8  
9  h2::before {  
10     content: counter(section, lower-alpha)  
11     ". ";  
12 }
```

Some commonly used list styles are:

- `decimal` (default)

1. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

2. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

- `decimal-leading-zero`

01. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

02. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

- lower-roman

i. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

ii. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

- upper-roman

I. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

II. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

- lower-alpha

a. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

b. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

- upper-alpha

A. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

B. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

Alternatively, you can define a custom style with `@counter-style`. This method is more advanced:

```
1  /* circled numbers (cycles after 10) */
2  @counter-style circled {
3      system: cyclic;
4      symbols: "①" "②" "③" "④" "⑤" "⑥"
5              "⑦" "⑧" "⑨" "⑩";
6      suffix: " ";
7  }
8
9  h2::before {
10     content: counter(section, circled);
11 }
```

①. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

②. H2 Heading

H3 Heading

H3 Heading

Nested counter

By combining multiple counters, you can create a nested numbering structure.

Remember to reset the inner counter when the outer counter increments so subsections start at 1.

```
1  body {
2    counter-reset: section;
3  }
4
5  h2 {
6    /* Reset h3 counter to 1 for every new
   h2 */
7    counter-reset: subsection;
8    counter-increment: section;
9  }
10
11 h3 {
12   counter-increment: subsection;
13 }
14
15 h2::before {
16   content: counter(section) ". ";
17 }
18
19 h3::before {
20   content: counter(section) "."
   counter(subsection) " ";
21 }
```

1. H2 Heading

1.1 H3 Heading

1.2 H3 Heading

1.3 H3 Heading

2. H2 Heading

2.1 H3 Heading

2.2 H3 Heading